

Speaking Part 3- Selected/Topic wise 30 Sample Questions and Answers

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Advertising

1. Do young and old people show the same attitude towards advertisements?

Certainly not. Every individual has his own unique attitude towards advertisements and the advantages and disadvantages that advertising brings. Both old and young people are inclined to believe and think that advertisements tend to be misleading, dishonest, phony, shallow, and at times annoying, especially when they're not well made or dorky. On the other hand, if done well, they can be very creative, humorous, artistic, and enjoyable to watch. Those, however, are the exception, rather than the norm.

2. Are advertisements a good or bad influence on children?

Looking at today's children, I would have to say advertisements have predominately had a negative influence on their lives and character. Ads create a discontentment with what children have and a desire to own more and to be like everyone else. Advertisements usually tend to be unrealistic and give a false impression of how the children should be or what will happen when they buy the product.

Law

3. Is there any situation people disobey the law?

To be honest, I've never actually seen anyone litter. I'm sure it must still exist to some low extent, but I genuinely think people are afraid to do so because of the fines and police presence. However, I know that no country is perfect and that there are always people who will disobey the law. On another note, I think that perhaps people who come to Singapore are more likely to throw their trash on the ground if it isn't something enforced in their home country.

Cellphones

4. Do you prefer face-to-face conversations or conversations by phone?

I genuinely prefer a face-to-face conversation as I feel that is a more personal way of talking to somebody. These days, with mobile phones gaining popularity, people have stopped spending time with each other and continue neglecting their loved ones. While phones are necessary, they should not create a hurdle between one another.

City & Countryside

5. Do you think it is better to live in the countryside or in the city?

As often as this question is raised, I believe it remains a tough decision to make when it comes to choosing between living in the countryside and living in the city. Many people have been attracted to live and work in big cities because of better employment opportunities and higher living standards. This massive rural-to-urban migration has, however, led to an increase in environmental pollution, traffic and social issues in urban areas. It would be a better idea for people to live in the suburb and travel into the city to work every day so that they can enjoy the best of both worlds.

Music

6. Do you think the Internet has affected the music industry? In what ways?

I definitely agree that internet has greatly affected the music industry. For one, I'm sure that some artists have lost money due to illegal internet downloads. Secondly, now artists are exposed to the world much more easily. In this cyber era, we have so much information at the click of a mouse. I'm sure that it is much easier to get your name out there nowadays. I wonder if the famous will become even more famous!

Weather

7. How do different seasons affect the way people feel?

One of the things that weather affects is the kind of food you eat, but when it's really hot I don't usually feel like eating a lot, just some fruit or quick and easy food, like sandwiches, cold noodles, whereas in the winter I usually feel like eating lots of food such as soups, rice, noodles. Also when it's hot I just feel like sleeping, but in the winter I'm naturally colder, so I have to move around to keep warm.

Work/Job

8. Which jobs would you say are most respected in your country?

Well, I have never thought about this, but I reckon that professional careers such as the fields of law, education, and medicine may be the most highly-acclaimed ones. It is mainly because people working in these fields can easily earn lucrative income compared to others.

9. Some people say it's better to work for yourself than be employed by a company. What's your opinion?

Well, I used to be a full-time employee & felt very stressed. To be specific, most of the time, I had a hectic schedule & was up to ears in heavy workloads to meet deadlines. Therefore, although running my own business is really challenging, I do feel far more comfortable with it.

10. What are some of the important things a candidate should find out before accepting a job?

Well, this is an interesting question. If I were offered a job, I would definitely go through the company's compensation package such as salary, allowances, maternity or paternity leave, insurance, pension plans, vacations, etc. Also, I'd need to know about my area of responsibilities so that I can make sure that I will not be overwhelmed with heavy workloads down the road.

Public speaking

11. Can you suggest any methods that would help reduce nervousness?

Each of us will surely experience at least once in our lifetime the feeling of anxiety. It can be before our job interview or big presentation, when meeting your family-in-law for the first time and so on. Nervousness could be a good sign since it shows that we care. However, to better perform at such life-changing events, you should control your feelings. Firstly, take a deep breath. You can't be at your best without breathing easily. Second, don't try convince yourself that you're not anxious. Accept it just like any other feelings then you don't have to keep reminding yourself to ignore it. Lastly, use positive self-talk. Encourage yourself and remember that you are in this place for a reason.

Shopping

12. Do you think it is good for people buy expensive clothes? Why?

People have their preferences when it comes to fashion, which satisfies both their taste and affordability. I believe it's more economically wise not to spend an excessive amount of money on clothing since such amount can be invested more efficiently. The first reason is fashions are short-lived. Once a specific type of clothing goes out of style, it is likely to be left untouched for eternity despite being worn a few times. Imagine the same thing happening with dozens of other pieces in your closet. The amount of money you waste will add up. Furthermore, it will be more beneficial to invest in experiences and knowledge rather than material items. Travelling and exploring the world will bring you more pleasure and wisdom than a fashionable dress ever could.

13. Why do some people like shopping with friends?

Plenty of people, including me, enjoy shopping with friends rather than by themselves because of some privileges they can't find otherwise. People tend to seek advice or ideas on the products or services when shopping. Hence, a companion can provide you with more objective and fairer remarks on the item you want to buy but are uncertain of, which is extremely helpful for fashion. Besides, it might be impossible for you to refrain from overspending, and that's where your co-shopper comes to your rescue. Before they let you go over your budget, they make sure you know the pros and cons. Thus, unless all my friends are occupied, I rarely go shopping alone.

Culture

14. How can we benefit from learning about other cultures?

Several ways that people can benefit from other cultures are in business, personal relationships, and just in self-improvement. In business, it is necessary to know a little bit about whatever culture you plan to work with. For instance, I think in Muslim cultures, shaking hands with your left hand is considered extremely rude. If you didn't know that, it could hurt your chances of doing business. Also, it's important just to improve yourself by learning as much as you can, and culture is a good subject.

15. Do you think globalization is a good thing?

Yes, globalization has its problems, but for the most part, it is good for most people involved. Some people have different opinions because they are really concerned with the loss of culture, but for me, the benefits outweigh the drawbacks. People have access to more information, so diseases can be better treated, food can be made more efficiently, and goods that make people's lives easier are now available.

Free time & Hobbies

16. How does finance affect the way people spend free time?

I see finance has profound impact on spending in spare time. While affluent people tend to spend their time playing golf or chilling out at spas, people having low income are likely to spend time at home, watch a movie. The more money we have, the more money we spend so that's why leisure pursuits vary according to finance.

Plan

17. Why do people make plans?

Some believe planning is not for everyone since many wants to live spontaneously without thinking too much but others have different opinions. People are into planning since many benefits it may bring. Planning helps you clarify your goals, strategize your tactics and stay on track. Even if sometimes you mess it all up, you will eventually get back to your ultimate destination. Without a plan, you are simply lost in a maze of inconsequential decisions.

Health

18. How can people be encouraged to stay healthy?

One of the best ways a person can be encouraged to stay healthy is by talking to them about the health benefits. They can even promote health benefits through advertisements. People will get motivated and adopt a healthy lifestyle.

Sports and Competition

19. What are the benefits of sport or exercise?

Exercise keeps you healthy. It's been proven that people who exercise more get sick less. When you exercise, it helps build your strength to fight sickness. I have a friend who has a bad back, and if he doesn't run, play basketball or exercise in some way then his back will go out and he'll have to stay in bed until it is better.

20. Do you prefer to watch sports events on TV at home or to watch them live?

Why?

I prefer watching sports on TV, because sometimes you're watching a game that looks like it will be loads of fun but it turns out to be super boring where your team gets creamed and you feel like crying. If you are at the stadium watching the game, there's nothing you can do but cry, but if you are at home you can just change the channel to something fun. Watching sports at home is also more economical, you can be watching 3 or 4 games for just a few more an hour.

Language

21. Do you think that all children should learn foreign languages at school?

Yes, children should be taught foreign languages in school from an early age. Foreign languages help improve children's ability to communicate, thereby improving their fluency and confidence in speaking. It will help them gain knowledge about foreign countries and increase their interests in their cultures.

22. Why is language an important aspect of culture?

Language is one of the most important aspects of the culture as it is the means by which people across the globe communicate with one another, build relationships, and create a sense of community. Language influences our cultural identities and our social realities.

People vs. Money

23. What do you think about money?

Money can do many things, both good and bad. It allows us to have freedom and a wide variety of choices. Money gives us confidence and desire to work harder so we can have a better life. You can decide where and how you want to live when you have a good income. When you do not have much money, your choices are limited. However, everything comes with a price. Having much money doesn't mean people won't run into problems. Most people fail to strike a balance between earning money and enjoying it, so they work day and night. They believe they'll be happier if they have lots of money. However, for most people, such time never comes and they die unhappy and dissatisfied.

24. Who do you think saves more money, men or women?

Well, it's hard to say. Men's biggest risk is their egos. They need to brag about their possessions and how much money they've earned, so they end up spending more money. Women tend to save money and spend it when they really need it. However, there are still exceptions when women manage money worse than men. That's why there is no strong proof to show men or women save more money.

Travelling

25. Do you think travel can (or, does) change people's ways of thinking?

I think travel has made people better communicators. It has allowed people to be more patient. Through travelling, people can get to know a lot more about the world around them. Travel increases the desire to meet new people and pushes one to explore all kinds of amazing, admirable things. You become a well-rounded person just by experience. Travelling focuses on a greater sense of empathy and we also gain knowledge about diverse cultures. Interaction with people is another pathway to revitalize our minds. I think travelling really develops a personality. They become less judgmental, more stable, and more open-minded, find themselves more optimistic, and don't panic often.

26. What are the disadvantages of not travelling?

There are many disadvantages of not travelling to a new place. Many educational and health benefits will be missed. We will be unable to learn new cultures and languages. Memories for a lifetime will really pass over. You will not be able to deal with the stress, if you don't take a break and travel. Also, you cannot sense and appreciate independence. You cannot boost confidence within yourself. You cannot realize your passion if you are not physically exploring places.

Universities.

27. Should all students pay for their university education? Why?

I do not think that the university cost should be paid solely by the students and their guardians. Since the government allocate budget for the education sector and a major portion of it goes for higher education and research facilities, state-run universities must offer free education. On top of that, the government has a responsibility to spend the taxpayers' money in social welfare and free or cheap education should be a top priority

Reading Books.

28. Do you generally read a lot of books or do you prefer watching TV? Why?

I prefer reading books over enjoying random programs on television. However, that does not mean that I hate watching TV. I just feel that reading is a far better habit than watching TV. Every book gives us the opportunity to learn something new and the time spent on reading a book is more constructive. I can't say the same for the TV. We often watch TV to kill our time and end up surfing through channels rather than watching something meaningful.

Internet.

29. Do you think all the information on the internet is true?

I believe without an authentic source and credible publisher; we should be wary of information we see or find online. The Internet is an astonishing source of information but the fake news and fabricated information are all around there. Thus, I would not believe everything I see online except they are from an authoritative source. For instance, if I find a piece of information on a website like www.bbc.com, from the official government website or from a prominent and mainstream online newspaper, I would believe it. However, any news found on a social networking website like Facebook, or from a dubious website should always be verified before believing it to be true.

30. Do you think the internet is safe for children to use unsupervised?

I believe, children should not be allowed to use the Internet without some sort of supervision from parents. The Internet is a great source of information and entertainment but it also contains harmful contents that could psychologically damage children and the predators often search for children to harm them. Thus, parents should either enforce a rigid parental control on the browser and network-level which would monitor online activities of children and filter out bad contents or should be present physically when their children use the Internet. It is not to take away children's freedom but for their safety.